

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
No.28. 8th of September 2025



WHY I LIKE JESUS THE THINGS ABOUT JESUS THAT I LIKE

OUR FOCUS:

THE REASONS I AM ATTRACTED TO CHRIST AND CAUSES ME TO LOVE HIM.

I thought it would be good for me to do the exercise of appraising what it is about Jesus that I liked. It might also be good for you to do the same.

THE HOLY SPIRIT.

IT IS CLEARLY AND EXCLUSIVELY **THE WORK OF THE HOLY SPIRIT THAT PRODUCES LOVE IN OUR HEARTS FOR CHRIST.**

BUT IT IS OUR KNOWING THE WRITTEN TRUTHS FROM SCRIPTURE ABOUT CHRIST JESUS **THAT THE HOLY SPIRIT USES TO PRODUCE LOVE IN OUR HEARTS FOR HIM.**

TRUTHS LIKE:

- **KNOWING WHO HE IS** TO US AS BELIEVERS – (the excellency of his person),
- **KNOWING HIS RELATIONSHIP** TO US PERSONALLY - (our union with Christ),
- **KNOWING WHAT HE HAS DONE** FOR US - (saved, reconciled, justified, etc.)
- **THESE ARE THE TRUTHS OF SCRIPTURE THAT THE HOLY SPIRIT TAKES AND WORKS TO FLAME OUR HEARTS WITH LOVE FOR JESUS.**

■ KNOWLEDGE IS NEVER STATIC (remaining the same) BUT EVER SEEKING TO UNVEIL A DEEPER AND WIDER UNDERSTANDING OF DIVINE TRUTH TO THE HUNGRY BELIEVER.

■ **IT IS THE SPIRIT THAT CAUSES US TO EXPERIENCE KNOWING TRUTH MORE DEEPLY AND PROFOUNDLY THAN WE KNEW PREVIOUSLY.**

EXAMPLE:

WE SHALL KNOW – IF WE CONTINUE TO FOLLOW ON

Hosea 6:3 *Oh, that we might know the Lord! LET US press on to know him. He will respond to us as surely as the arrival of dawn or the coming of rains in early spring." NLT*

Hosea 6:3 *Then shall we know, IF WE FOLLOW ON to know the LORD: his going forth is prepared as the morning; and he will come to us as the rain, as the latter and former rain to the earth. Webster*

I Love Him because:

- **HE FIRST LOVED ME** -1 John 4:19 *We love him, because he first loved us. KJV*
- **HE GAVE HIMSELF FOR ME** - Galatians 2:20 *the Son of God, who loved me, and gave himself for me. KJV*

I Love Him because:

- **OF THE EXCELLENCY OF HIS PERSON.**
- **HE IS ALTOGETHER LOVELY and EVERYTHING ABOUT HIM DELIGHTS ME.**
- **OF HIS GRACIOUSNESS AND MERCIFULNESS.**

- OF HIS LOVE AND REVERENCE FOR HIS HEAVENLY FATHER AND HIS PASSION TO CARRY OUT HIS FATHER'S WISHES.
- OF HIS SERVANT ATTITUDE.

I Love Him because:

- OF HIS LOVE FOR PEOPLE.
- OF HIS EMPATHY WITH PEOPLE'S CIRCUMSTANCES.
- OF HIS COMPASSION HIS CARE/CONCERN FOR THE UNDERPRIVILEGED AND THE REJECTED.
- OF HIS EMPATHY AND UNDERSTANDING OF PEOPLE'S PLIGHT.
- OF HIS WISDOM IN HIS APPLICATION.

I Love Him because:

- OF HIS AUTHORITY AND POWER – **his Exousia – his Dynamis**

EXAMPLE:

HOW I SAW AND UNDERSTOOD JESUS IN THE DIFFERENT STAGES OF MY LIFE (that obviously reflected my level of love for Jesus).

1. IN AN EARLY STAGE OF MY LIFE

When I was around 6 years of age, I was moved to tears whenever I played an old gramophone record that I got from Mum and Dad. It was called "The Stranger of Galilee."

The song – "In Fancy, I stood by the shore one day - Of a beautiful murmuring sea - I saw the great crowds as they throned - Of the stranger of Galilee –

I saw how the man who was blind from birth - In a moment was made to see

The Lamb were made whole by the matchless skill - Of the stranger of Galilee.

I did not know who the stranger of Galilee was, but listening to the lyrics somehow moved me, and I always cried. But it left me with the feeling of empathy and sorry for those needy people.

2. THEN IN MY LATER TEENS

From some people I heard references about God and Jesus, but none of these references left any obvious impression on me. My father and mother taught me right and wrong and important things about personal integrity and honesty, etc. – but while these were good and true, I did not always follow them.

I did not go to church or have any thought of being religious, and just did what the other young men of my small town did, and God, church and religion were not part of our lifestyle.

3. AT 20 YEARS OF AGE

My first direct encounter of being directly spoken to about Jesus was when I was walking along the road to see my parents in another town that a man in his car stopped and gave me a ride. He told me about God and Jesus and God's judgement and I was affected not only because of the high speed he was driving at but also because of what he said about God's judgement. However, I thought nothing more about it after I got out of his car.

THEN some weeks later, one of the young employees of the company I worked for spoke to me about the change in her life because she had discovered Jesus and invited me to go to church, which I quickly declined.

4. THEN AT THE AGE OF 21 YEARS

I met Jesus Christ personally and in the early stages of my Christian life, I knew him as **my saviour, Lord, baptiser in the Holy Spirit, healer and my soon coming King.**

But as I progressed in my walk with Christ, **my knowledge of His person, His power, His plan and purpose for my life became clearer to me.**

As my hunger for Christ grew so did my knowledge of Him and desire to know him more and this resulted in the Holy Spirit **continuing to inflame my heart with passionate love for Christ.**

Growing up in Christ has been a wonderful adventure for me and hopefully for you too.

Jude 21 keep yourselves in the love of God, ESV

Jude 21 Stay always within the boundaries where God's love can reach and bless you. TLB

Amen - Ps Barry